

STAGE SIX • COMMUNICATION: SPEAKING, READING & WRITING

FIRSTS

SESSION DEBRIEF / CLOSE-OUT SCRIPT

How to end each session, summarize, and bridge to what's next

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Session Debrief / Close-Out Script

Stage Six • Communication: Speaking, Reading & Writing

WHY THIS MATTERS

A genuine close-out does three things every time: names what was actually accomplished, connects it forward to what's next, and gives a specific, concrete action to take before the next session. Given this stage's size, a clear closing thread matters even more than usual — without it, seventy individual FIRSTS can start to feel like a checklist rather than a coherent skill built over six sessions.

Close-Out Scripts

SESSION 1

Closing Session 1

"Today covered seventeen FIRSTS, all in writing: emails, reports, proposals, meeting documentation, and a library of templates to speed up future work."

"The throughline today was clarity — stating your purpose early, editing separately from drafting, and writing for your reader's time, not just your own thoroughness."

"Before next time: bring your phone. We're moving from the page to your actual voice, and there's real recording involved."

SESSION 2

Closing Session 2

"That was our most demanding session yet — scripting, delivering, recording, debating, and speaking with zero preparation. Real credit to everyone for pushing through the discomfort."

"If today felt uncomfortable, that discomfort is exactly the signal that real growth happened. Comfortable practice rarely produces real improvement."

"Before next time: no special prep, just come ready to genuinely listen and read closely."

SESSION 3

Closing Session 3

"Today flipped the lens from producing communication to receiving it: active listening, reading comprehension, and building a genuine reading habit for your field."

"The skill most people underestimate is genuine, active listening — today gave you a real, concrete way to check your own retention rather than just assuming you were paying attention."

"Before next time: come ready to talk to people, including some genuine role-play of harder conversations."

SESSION 4

Closing Session 4

"Today was live, interpersonal communication: networking, mock interviews, facilitation, cross-cultural awareness, and conflict conversations most people actively avoid."

"If you role-played a difficult conversation today, notice that it was genuinely survivable — that's real evidence you can carry into an actual version of that conversation later."

"Before next time: bring a real piece of your own work for our feedback exercises."

SESSION 5

Closing Session 5

"Today turned inward: giving and receiving feedback, honest self-assessment, and examining your own public speaking anxiety and persuasion instincts specifically."

"Self-awareness at this level of specificity, not just 'I should communicate better' but genuinely knowing your own patterns, is what makes the next session's systems actually stick."

"Before next time: think about which of this stage's exercises felt most genuinely useful to you — we'll build on that in our final session."

SESSION 6

Closing Session 6 (Stage Close)

"That's Stage Six, complete — all seventy FIRSTS, across written communication, speaking, listening and reading, interpersonal skill, feedback and reflection, and now, systems to make it all sustainable."

"This was the largest stage in the entire program. If it felt like a lot, that's because it was — communication genuinely touches everything else you'll do professionally, which is why it warranted this much depth."

"Before we close: name one specific communication habit that's already different for you than it was six sessions ago. Not something you plan to change — something that's already genuinely shifted."

"Stage Seven picks up with Hard Skills — the technical and functional capabilities that everything you've built here in communication will help you actually demonstrate and explain."